

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

NEW STATE RECORD ☐UNUSUAL RECORD ☒

Please print or type. Attach photographs and additional pages if necessary.

Species: Purple Finch | Carpodacus purpureus
(Vernacular Name) (Scientific Name)Date(s): 12/27/80Number of birds seen: One Sex: ♀ Plumage: - Ad.Locality: Poudre River at Lemay Street Bridge Elevation: ~4800'Nearest town: Fort Collins County: LarimerTime(s) observed: 1220. → 1235.Duration of observation (e.g. 1 sec., 5 min., etc.): 15 MIN.

Other observers who saw the bird with you (give names, addresses, telephone numbers):

Barry F. Van Sant 482-0564
4408 Stable Lane
Fort Collins, CO

Other observers who saw the bird independently (give names, addresses, telephone numbers)

Light conditions (position of bird to light and shade, direction and strength of light):
Bird sitting in sun light, side-lit in even light; also in shade of shrubs and on groundOptical equipment used (e.g. power, types): 7x35 BUSHNELL WIDE-ANGLE BINOCULARSDistance, and how measured: 6-10m ; estimatedIf photographed, type of equipment and film: -Who else photographed the bird? -

Describe the bird's behavior (e.g. flying, feeding, or habits used in identifying):

Travelling with ~25 House Finches; feeding in weeds and in Prunus shrubs; preening;
Flying.

Describe in detail the bird's relative size, overall shape, plumage and color pattern. Include details of bill, wing and tail shape. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird. Reference to its resemblance to field guide descriptions and illustrations is not enough. Describe only what you actually observe in the field:

Same general size as House Finch; "chunky"; stout bill; auricular patch, malar patch, forehead, crown, and nape + back all deep brown; white superciliary stripe, throat white, breast and flanks white heavily streaked with deep brown; belly less streaked to white on lower; tail wide and notched; no wing or tail bars; nape and back obscurely

Description (continued):

Describe the bird's song and call, if given, including method of delivery, (i.e. from perch, in flight, duration): None.

Describe the general and specific habitat in which you observed the bird:

Riparian mosaic - cottonwood forest with grasses, weeds, and shrubs. Birds flocking along shrubby embankment dominated by Prunus.

How did you eliminate similarly appearing species?

- Much more heavily streaked ^{below} than nearby house finches; deeper brown than both Cassin's and House finches; auricular patch very dark, and distinct superciliary line separate it from both these species and Song Sparrow; habits (flight, presence with other finches) also separate it from the latter. Larger and more distinct markings than siskin; smaller and shorter-tailed than Fox Sparrow.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species?

Very familiar with this species in the eastern U.S.; also very familiar with all similar species mentioned. have worked in areas where Cassin's Finches and House Finches breed; have seen all three Carpodacus finches together in this exact location in the past; have seen this particular species on at least three previous occasions in the Ft. Collins area.
List books, illustrations, recordings, other birders, etc. consulted and how this influenced your identification:

a) at time of observation: Robbins, et. al. to confirm ID and explain same to the other observer with me who has far less experience.

b) after observation: None.

This report was written from reports made during _____, after observation X from memory X
Date and time report was written: 1130. ; 29 December 1980 for CBC results

Reporting observer: Daniel C. Butler Signature: Daniel C. Butler

Address: 9092 W. Ramona, Littleton, CO 80125

All reports will be maintained permanently at the address below:

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